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**Power couple Imran Chaudhri and Bethany Bongiorno has been involved in the making of some of the most iconic tech products. Chaudhri, a British-American designer, spent nearly 22 years at Apple and played a crucial role in shaping the design and user experience of some of its most popular products. Having worked alongside Steve Jobs and Apple CEO Tim Cook, Chaudhri was one of the main forces behind the design language for the Mac, iPod, iPhone, iPad, and more. Bongiorno, a software engineer who spent more than eight years at Apple, worked on iOS and macOS and played a pivotal role in the launch of the original iPad.**

**While they understand the transformative power of technology, they also recognised a growing pain point—the constant pull of smartphones and the way tech was beginning to overshadow humanity. They believe that “the future is not your face”. This shared vision became the genesis of Humane Inc., founded in 2018.**

**Their first product is the Ai Pin, which imagines a future where AI seamlessly integrates into our everyday lives, an almost inconspicuous companion whispering useful suggestions whenever invoked. A screen-less wearable, the Ai Pin acts as an intelligent assistant, which reduces your screen time on the smartphone. A simple voice command or gesture allows you to capture a photo, translate a**

**conversation on the go, or summarise your chats using AI. And if you want to see the output instead of hearing it, the pin can project it onto your palm with an in-built laser projector. The device runs on its own operating system, Cosmos, which can be powered by the multiple large language models (LLMs) for Gen AI available in the market, including OpenAI’s ChatGPT and Google’s Gemini.**

**While the product is available in the US, it hasn’t been smooth sailing for Humane. At the time of going to press, there were unconfirmed reports that the company was exploring a potential sale. Meanwhile, the Ai Pin has been hit by a spate of negative reviews by very popular tech influencers. A lot of these reviews point out its shortcomings—battery life, responsiveness, pricing (it starts at \$699 in the US, with a subscription plan of \$24 a month) and**

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**“We believe that customers should own their own data and not have anyone else being able to use and exploit it”**

**the fact that it is still an unfinished product. But that’s the challenge of bringing a revolutionary product to an otherwise stagnant market.**

**Products and strategies will evolve, but given the support Humane has received from some of the most influential names in tech, these criticisms are unlikely to negate its long-term vision. Among the big names that have invested are OpenAI’s Sam Altman, Microsoft, SK Networks, LG Technology Ventures, Tiger Global, Qualcomm Ventures and Volvo Cars Tech Fund.**

**In an interaction with *Business Today’s***